

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 • 1558–1569**Queen, Government and Religion, 1558–69**

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: Queen Elizabeth I in Coronation Robes (c. 1600)

NPG 2607 • NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON

Key topic 1: Queen, government and religion, 1558–69

1 The situation on Elizabeth's accession	• Elizabethan England in 1558: society and government. • The Virgin Queen: the problem of her legitimacy, gender, marriage. Her character and strengths. • Challenges at home and from abroad: financial weaknesses, religious divisions, the French threat.
2 The 'settlement' of religion	• Elizabeth's religious settlement (1559): its features and impact. • The Church of England: its role in society.
3 Challenge to the religious settlement	• The nature and extent of the Puritan challenge. • The nature and extent of the Catholic challenge, including the role of the nobility, Papacy and foreign powers.
4 The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots	• Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the English throne. • Relations between Elizabeth and Mary, 1568–69.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

17 NOV 1558 • Accession of Elizabeth I & Council Appointments

Key Topic 1.1

Mary I dies; 25-year-old Elizabeth succeeds to the throne. She immediately appoints trusted Protestant statesman Sir William Cecil as her Principal Secretary, confronting £300,000 in Crown debts and French military forces stationed in Scotland.

MAY 1559 • The Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity (The Settlement)

Key Topic 1.2

Parliament passes the Religious Settlement. The Act of Supremacy establishes Elizabeth as 'Supreme Governor' of the Church of England; the Act of Uniformity mandates the 1559 Book of Common Prayer and imposes a 1 shilling fine for recusancy.

SUMMER 1559 • The Royal Injunctions & National Visitations

Key Topic 1.2

The Crown issues 57 Royal Injunctions enforcing Protestant worship. Clergy must preach royal supremacy, condemn papal authority, report recusants, and use English bibles. National visitations by 125 commissioners inspect parish compliance.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

JULY 1560 • The Treaty of Edinburgh

Key Topic 1.1 / 1.4

French troops withdraw from Scotland after a rebellion by Protestant Scottish lords. The Treaty establishes peace and Mary, Queen of Scots gives up her claim to the English throne, though Mary refuses to formally ratify the agreement.

1566 • The Vestments Controversy & Puritan Dissent

Key Topic 1.3

Archbishop Matthew Parker issues the 'Book of Advertisements' requiring all clergy to wear the surplice and tippet. In London, 37 Puritan vicars refuse to wear Catholic-style vestments and are deprived of their livings, revealing deep Protestant divisions.

MAY 1568 • Mary Queen of Scots Flees to England

Key Topic 1.4

Following the murder of Lord Darnley and defeat at Carberry Hill, Catholic Mary Stuart flees Scotland in a fishing boat to Workington, Cumberland. Elizabeth places her under armed house arrest, triggering twenty years of Catholic conspiracy.

How dangerous was the crisis facing Elizabeth I upon her accession in 1558?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 17 NOV 1558 Accession of Elizabeth I • Mary I dies (17 Nov 1558); 25-year-old Elizabeth succeeds to the throne. • Inherits Crown debt of £300,000 to Antwerp moneylenders. • Appoints Sir William Cecil as Principal Secretary to direct royal policy.	<i>Why did inherited debt and foreign loans create an immediate crisis for the new Queen?</i>
2 NOV–DEC 1558 Features of Elizabethan Government • The Court: personal household, noble advisers, and ceremonial displays of power. • The Privy Council: 19 wealthy noblemen directing day-to-day royal government. • System of Patronage: royal distribution of titles, land, offices, and monopolies.	<i>How did Elizabeth use patronage and factional competition to secure political control?</i>
3 DEC 1558 Challenges of Gender & Legitimacy • 16th-century Christian teaching on male authority and monarchs (queen regnant). • Henry VIII & Anne Boleyn: marriage declared invalid by Pope Clement VII. • 1536 Second Succession Act: declared Elizabeth illegitimate after Anne's execution.	<i>Why did challenges to Elizabeth's gender and legitimacy threaten domestic stability?</i>
4 JAN–MAY 1559 Parliament & Local Government • Parliament: House of Lords and Commons called for legislation and extraordinary taxation. • Justices of the Peace (JPs): unpaid county gentry responsible for local law and order. • Lord Lieutenants: wealthy nobles commanding the county militia and regional defenses.	<i>Why was Elizabeth entirely dependent on unpaid local gentry to enforce royal authority?</i>
5 1558–1560 Foreign Threats: France & Scotland • 1558: England loses Calais to France during the reign of Mary I. • The Auld Alliance: traditional military alliance between France and Scotland. • Mary, Queen of Scots: married to French Dauphin Francis II; claims English crown.	<i>Why did the Auld Alliance and the loss of Calais make England vulnerable to foreign invasion?</i>

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Not examined in 7 years)

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the role of the Privy Council in 1558.

Target Guidance: Point (A group of 19 noble advisors who guided royal policy and administration) • Fact (Led by William Cecil, they debated daily on war, finance, and treason, but the Queen had the final prerogative).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was that the Privy Council... Specifically, led by Sir William Cecil, they...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel June 2022 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558.

Target Guidance: Point (The Crown was in crippling debt of £300,000 inherited from Mary I) • Fact (Crown income had fallen due to inflation and selling royal land; debasement of the coinage ruined English credit abroad).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was the massive Crown debt inherited from Mary I... Specifically, the debt stood at...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the challenges Elizabeth faced regarding marriage in 1558.

Target Guidance: Point (Intense pressure to produce a Protestant heir and secure foreign alliances) • Fact (Marriage to an English noble created factional jealousy; marrying a foreign Catholic prince risked foreign domination like Mary I and Philip II).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was the intense political dilemma over marriage... Specifically, Elizabeth was wary because...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1). In Milestone 1, sketch the Tudor Rose crown and note Elizabeth's £300,000 inherited debt.

← Pages 2–3

Score: [/ 12]

You may use in your answer: • Her parents' marriage • Mary, Queen of Scots *(You must also use information of your own.)*

POINT
1

POINT
2

POINT 3

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Question 2 Continued

HISTORICAL VERDICT

[illegible]

Was Elizabeth's Religious Settlement a brilliant compromise or an unstable truce?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 NOV 1558–JAN 1559 Religious Divisions in 1558 • North and West: Catholic heartlands (Durham, Yorkshire, Lancashire, Wales). • South-East and London: growing Protestant populations and returning Marian exiles. • House of Lords: Catholic bishops appointed by Mary I opposing religious reform.	<i>Why did England's geographic and political divisions make a religious settlement essential?</i>
2 MAY 1559 The Act of Supremacy • Re-established English Church independence from the authority of the Pope in Rome. • Elizabeth declared 'Supreme Governor' of the Church of England. • Compulsory Oath of Supremacy for all clergy and royal officials.	<i>Why did Elizabeth choose the title 'Supreme Governor' instead of 'Supreme Head'?</i>
3 MAY 1559 The Act of Uniformity • 1559 Book of Common Prayer in English made compulsory in all parish churches. • Communion wording: combines 1549 and 1552 Protestant and Catholic phrasing. • Recusancy fine of one shilling (12d) per Sunday for failing to attend church.	<i>How did the Act of Uniformity attempt to compromise between Catholic and Protestant worship?</i>
4 SUMMER 1559 The Royal Injunctions • 57 royal instructions to clergy enforcing the Acts of Supremacy and Uniformity. • Mandatory English Bible in each parish; pilgrimages and fake miracles banned. • Vestments: clergy required to wear special vestments (surplice) during services.	<i>How did the Royal Injunctions establish central royal control over local parish life?</i>
5 1559–1560s Enforcing the Settlement & Church Role • Royal Visitations: 125 commissioners inspect parishes; 400 clergy deprived of livings. • Only one Catholic bishop out of fifteen takes the Oath of Supremacy. • Church Courts: legal control over marriage, moral conduct, slander, and wills.	<i>How effectively did royal visitations and Church courts enforce conformity across England?</i>

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] ★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel SAMs (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559).

Target Guidance: Point (Made Elizabeth Supreme Governor of the Church of England rather than Supreme Head) • Fact (All clergy and royal officials had to take an Oath of Supremacy acknowledging her title or lose their posts).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was that Elizabeth took the title of Supreme Governor... Specifically, this required all clergy to...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS Edexcel June 2023 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Royal Injunctions of 1559.

Target Guidance: Point (A set of 57 practical instructions issued by William Cecil to enforce church conformity) • Fact (Commanded clergy to preach royal supremacy, keep an English Bible, report recusants, and ban unapproved preaching).

Sentence Stems: One key feature of the Royal Injunctions was to enforce uniform Protestant practice... Specifically, they ordered that...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Act of Uniformity (1559).

Target Guidance: Point (Enforced identical church worship and prayer book throughout England) • Fact (Made church attendance compulsory on Sundays with a one-shilling recusancy fine and reinstated the 1552 Protestant Book of Common Prayer).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the legal enforcement of uniform church services... Specifically, the Act established that...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch the open English Book of Common Prayer and note the 1 shilling recusancy fine.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL SAMs
(Q3)

★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST

Score: [/ 20]

'Elizabeth's religious settlement of 1559 was completely successful in pleasing all religious groups.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • The Act of Uniformity (1559) • The Puritan challenge *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: SUCCESSFUL VIA MEDIA

POINT
1

Explain how the Settlement successfully achieved a broad Middle Way: moderate Protestant theology (English services, Book of Common Prayer) combined with Catholic outward ritual (vestments, candles) to prevent civil war.

2. CRITERIA 2: PURITAN DISCONTENT

**POINT
2**

Explain that the Settlement failed to satisfy zealous Puritans: they condemned the crucifix and vestments as "idolatrours popish rags" and challenged Elizabeth's authority in the 1566 Vestments Controversy.

3. CRITERIA 3: CATHOLIC ALIENATION

POINT
3

Explain that devout Catholics could not accept Elizabeth as Supreme Governor; almost all Catholic bishops resigned in 1559, recusancy grew in the North, and the Pope later excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Continued

VERDICT

[illegible]

Which group posed the greater danger to Elizabeth: zealous Puritans or defiant Catholics?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 1559–1563 The Nature of the Puritan Challenge • Puritans (strict Protestants): Marian exiles influenced by Geneva and Calvinist teaching. • Demanded removal of crucifixes, statues, altars, organs, and holy days from churches. • Rejected bishops and argued congregations should choose their own ministers.	Why did Puritan religious demands pose a direct challenge to Elizabeth's royal authority?
2 1566 The Crucifix & Vestments Controversy • Elizabeth orders crucifixes and candles retained in Royal Chapel and parish churches. • Archbishop Matthew Parker issues Book of Advertisements (1566) enforcing clergy dress. • 37 London vicars refuse to wear the surplice and are dismissed from their posts.	Why did the dispute over clergy vestments become a major test of Elizabeth's control?
3 1559–1568 The Catholic Challenge at Home • Church Papists: attended Church of England outwardly while practicing Catholic Mass at home. • Recusants: Catholic gentry and nobility who paid fines rather than attend services. • 1566: Pope Pius V issues instruction forbidding English Catholics from attending services.	Why was Elizabeth able to tolerate moderate Catholic non-conformity during the early 1560s?
4 1562–1568 Foreign Threats: France & The Netherlands • 1562: Outbreak of French Wars of Religion; 1564 Peace of Troyes ends Calais claims. • 1566: Dutch Protestant rebellion against Spanish Catholic rule in the Netherlands. • 1567: Philip II sends the Duke of Alba with 10,000 Spanish soldiers to Netherlands.	Why did the arrival of Alba's Spanish army in the Netherlands alarm the English Privy Council?
5 1568–1569 Escalating Tensions: The Genoese Loan • Alba's Council of Troubles: thousands of Dutch Protestants sentenced to death. • Nov 1568: English privateers seize Spanish ships sheltering in English ports. • Genoese Loan: £85,000 (400,000 florins) lent by Italian bankers seized by Elizabeth.	How did the seizure of the Genoese Loan push England and Spain closer to open conflict?

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] MEDIUM FREQUENCY Edexcel November 2020 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Vestments Controversy (1566).

Target Guidance: Point (Puritan vicars refused to wear the surplice ordered by Archbishop Parker) • Fact (Parker held an exhibition in London; 37 clergy refused to conform and were stripped of their livings and church posts).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was the clash over clerical dress... Specifically, Archbishop Parker insisted on the surplice, but 37 London clergy...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS Edexcel June 2024 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of recusancy in early Elizabethan England.

Target Guidance: Point (Catholics secretly practiced the Latin Mass and refused compulsory Sunday church services) • Fact (They paid a 1 shilling fine each week; in the North, wealthy Catholic gentry protected recusant priests).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature of recusancy was refusal to attend the new Anglican church... Specifically, recusants held secret Latin masses and paid...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Puritan challenge over crucifixes.

Target Guidance: Point (Puritans objected to crucifixes as Catholic idolatry representing graven images) • Fact (Puritan bishops threatened to resign when Elizabeth ordered crucifixes displayed in every church, forcing her to compromise by removing them from parish churches).**Sentence Stems:** One key feature was strong Puritan resistance to visual symbols of Catholicism... Specifically, Puritans argued that...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the plain Puritan surplice and the crossed-out Catholic crucifix.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] **EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q2)**

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q2)

★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement between 1559 and 1566.

You may use in your answer: • Vestments • The Crucifix Controversy *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: VESTMENTS & POPISH RAGS

POINT 1

Explain that Puritans, influenced by Genevan Calvinism, viewed priestly vestments (surplices) as unscriptural Catholic idolatry that set clergy apart from ordinary congregations.

2. CAUSE 2: CRUCIFIXES & GRAVEN IMAGES

**POINT
2**

Explain that Puritans believed crucifixes violated the Ten Commandments against graven images; several Puritan bishops threatened to resign when Elizabeth insisted on a crucifix in her chapel.

3. CAUSE 3: BISHOPS & LITURGICAL PURITY

**POINT
3**

Explain that Puritans wanted to eradicate the hierarchy of bishops and eradicate holy days, organs, and kneeling at communion, aiming for an entirely purified biblical church.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Enquiry 1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement • Question 2 INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL
Continued HISTORICAL VERDICT

[illegible]

Was Mary, Queen of Scots an innocent royal refugee or an existential threat to the realm?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition

1 1560–1565 Mary's Claim to the English Throne • Mary Stuart: great-granddaughter of Henry VII and Elizabeth's second cousin. • 1560: French husband Francis II dies; Mary returns from France to rule Scotland. • 1565: Mary marries Catholic Lord Darnley, uniting rival Stuart claims to English throne.	Why did Mary Stuart's royal ancestry and marriage choices threaten Elizabeth's security?
2 FEB 1567 The Murder of Lord Darnley • Feb 1567: Darnley's house at Kirk o' Field blown up; Darnley found strangled in garden. • James Hepburn, Earl of Bothwell, widely suspected of organising the assassination. • May 1567: Mary marries Bothwell following a Protestant ceremony at Holyrood.	Why did Darnley's murder and Mary's marriage to Bothwell ruin her authority in Scotland?
3 1567–1568 Abdication, Lochleven & Escape • June 1567: Scottish Protestant lords capture Mary and imprison her at Lochleven Castle. • Forced to abdicate in favor of infant son King James VI, with Earl of Moray as regent. • May 1568: Mary escapes Lochleven, defeated at Langside, and flees across Solway to England.	Why did Mary's unexpected arrival in England present Elizabeth with an impossible dilemma?
4 1568–1569 The Inquiry at York & Casket Letters • Oct 1568–Jan 1569: Formal commission at York and Westminster investigates Darnley's murder. • Casket Letters: eight love letters and poems allegedly written by Mary to Bothwell. • Commission delivers an official verdict of 'not proven', leaving Mary in royal custody.	Why did Elizabeth choose an inconclusive verdict rather than declaring Mary guilty or innocent?
5 1569 Mary's Imprisonment in England • Mary moved south to Tutbury Castle under armed guard of Earl of Shrewsbury. • Thomas Howard, Duke of Norfolk: secret plan to marry Mary with noble backing. • Nov 1569: Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland summon northern tenants to rebellion.	Why did Mary Stuart's presence in England inevitably lead to armed Catholic rebellion?

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] MEDIUM FREQUENCY Edexcel November 2021 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne.

Target Guidance: Point (Mary was the great-granddaughter of Henry VII through Margaret Tudor) • Fact (Because Catholics viewed Elizabeth as illegitimate, many regarded Mary as the rightful, legitimate Catholic Queen of England).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Mary's legitimate Tudor bloodline... Specifically, as great-granddaughter of Henry VII, English Catholics viewed her as...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] ★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Never examined) ★ High-Yield Forecast (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the inquiry into the Casket Letters (1568–69).

Target Guidance: Point (A commission held at York and Westminster to investigate whether Mary plotted Darnley's murder) • Fact (Elizabeth reached a "not proven" verdict; this allowed her to keep Mary detained in England without executing an anointed queen).

Sentence Stems: One key feature of the Casket Letters inquiry was to determine Mary's guilt... Specifically, the inquiry concluded with a verdict of...

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in May 1568.

Target Guidance: Point (Mary fled Scotland after Protestant nobles defeated her and sought Elizabeth's military aid) • Fact (Elizabeth placed Mary under house arrest in the north because her presence as a legitimate Catholic claimant threatened English stability).

Sentence Stems: One key feature of Mary's arrival was the acute security crisis it posed... Specifically, Elizabeth decided to...

TIMELINE MISSION

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch Carlisle Castle where Mary Stuart was first held under house arrest in 1568.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022
(Q3A)

CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Score: [/
20]

‘The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the main cause of instability in Elizabethan government.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer:

- Mary's claim to the throne
- Religious divisions in the North

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: MARY AS CATHOLIC FIGUREHEAD

POINT
1

Explain how Mary's physical presence provided a live, legitimate Catholic alternative to Elizabeth, immediately attracting discontented northern nobles and foreign Catholic conspirators.

2. CRITERIA 2: PRE-EXISTING NORTHERN DISCONTENT

POINT
2

Explain that the North was already deeply Catholic and alienated by Cecil's centralizing Protestant government; the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland had lost land and influence before 1568.

3. CRITERIA 3: SUCCESSION & DIPLOMATIC RISK

POINT 3

Explain that Elizabeth had no heir; Mary's presence forced foreign powers (France, Spain, Papacy) to view Elizabeth as expendable, turning Mary into a catalyst for domestic rebellion.

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Enquiry 1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots • Question 3 Continued INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL HISTORICAL VERDICT

[illegible]

THEMATIC STUDY BLUEPRINT • KEY TOPIC 1: QUEEN, GOVERNMENT & RELIGION, 1558–69

1. ANATOMY OF ELIZABETHAN GOVERNMENT: POWER, PATRONAGE & PREROGATIVE



The Monarch (Queen Elizabeth I):

Ruled by Divine Right. Held Royal Prerogative: foreign policy, war, marriage, religion. Could summon and dismiss Parliament at will.



The Privy Council (Led by William Cecil):

Approx. 19 trusted senior advisors who met daily. Managed government expenditure, state security, military logistics, and royal policy.



Parliament (Lords & Commons):

Met only 10 times in 44 years. Primary power: voting extraordinary taxation (subsidies) and passing statute laws. Free speech was restricted.



Local Government (Lords Lieutenant & JPs):

Lords Lieutenant commanded county militias. Unpaid JPs (gentry) enforced laws locally: collected taxes, regulated wages, punished vagrants.

2. THE RELIGIOUS SPECTRUM: RADICAL PURITANS VS ELIZABETH'S VIA MEDIA VS ROMAN CATHOLICS

PURITAN REFORMERS

- **Doctrine:** Strict Calvinism; predestination.
- **Governance:** Presbytery committees (no bishops).
- **Worship:** Plain sermons, no vestments (surplices), no crucifixes or organs.
- **Controversies:** 1566 Vestments Crisis (37 suspended); Crucifix Controversy.

ELIZABETH'S VIA MEDIA (1559)

- **Act of Supremacy:** Elizabeth = Supreme Governor.
- **Act of Uniformity:** Mandated 1559 Common Prayer Book.
- **Compromise:** Ambiguous Communion wording; traditional clergy vestments & hymns kept.
- **Enforcement:** 1s recusancy fine for missing church; 1559 Royal Injunctions (English Bible in parishes).

ROMAN CATHOLIC CHURCH

- **Authority:** The Pope in Rome = Supreme Head.
- **Doctrine:** 7 Sacraments; Latin Mass; Transubstantiation (bread/wine = real Christ).
- **Ritual:** Latin liturgy, stained glass, crucifixes, incense, holy water, saint relics.
- **Resistance:** Recusancy in Northern counties; secret household Latin Masses.

3. FOREIGN THREATS & STRATEGIC SECURITY DILEMMAS IN 1558



France & Calais:

England lost Calais in Jan 1558 (Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis). France was at peace with Spain, freeing French forces to threaten England.



Scotland & Auld Alliance:

Mary of Guise ruled Scotland with French troops stationed on border. Mary Stuart claimed English throne; French arms could invade north.

Spain & Philip II:

Philip II was ex-king consort (married Mary I). Wanted alliance against France, proposed marriage to Elizabeth, but was staunchly Catholic.



Treaty of Edinburgh (1560):

Scottish Protestant lords rebelled against French rule; Elizabeth sent fleet to Leith; Treaty secured French withdrawal from Scotland.

4. MONARCHICAL CHALLENGES: LEGITIMACY, MARRIAGE DILEMMAS & CROWN FINANCES



Marriage & Succession Crisis:

Parliament pressured Elizabeth to marry and produce Protestant heir. Foreign suitors (Philip II, Archduke Charles) risked foreign domination; English nobles (Dudley) caused factional jealousy.



Legitimacy & Gender Dilemma:

Catholics considered Henry VIII's marriage to Anne Boleyn illegal, declaring Elizabeth illegitimate. 16th-century society believed female rule was "unnatural" and inherently weak.



Crown Finances & Debt:

Inherited £300,000 debt from Mary I. Sold Crown lands and cut court costs under William Cecil; reformed debased coinage to restore Antwerp credit rating.

MASTER KNOWLEDGE ORGANISER • KEY TOPIC 1: QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558–69

1. CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL DEFINITIONS • Royal Prerogative: The monarch's exclusive customary powers over foreign policy, declaring war, marriage, and religion. • Via Media: The "Middle Way": Elizabeth's religious settlement balancing Protestant doctrine with traditional ritual. • Act of Uniformity (1559): Mandated the Book of Common Prayer, church ornaments, vestments, and imposed a 1s recusancy fine. • Vestments Controversy: 1566 crisis where 37 Puritan vicars were suspended for refusing Archbishop Parker's order to wear surplices. • Privy Council: A committee of around 19 trusted noble advisers who met daily to run government, finance, and security. • Act of Supremacy (1559): Established Elizabeth as "Supreme Governor" of the Church of England, requiring all clergy to take an oath. • Recusancy: Refusing to attend compulsory Church of England Sunday services; practiced by devout Roman Catholics. • Succession: The legal right to inherit the crown; Elizabeth refused to name a successor throughout her reign.	
2. ESSENTIAL CHRONOLOGY • 1558: Elizabeth succeeds Mary I • 1559: Act of Supremacy passed • 1559: Act of Uniformity passed • 1559: Royal Injunctions issued • 1560: Treaty of Edinburgh signed • 1566: Vestments Controversy (Parker) • 1567: Murder of Lord Darnley • 1568: Mary Stuart flees to England • 1568–69: York & Westminster inquiry • 1569: Northern Earls revolt breaks out	3. KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES MATRIX • Queen Elizabeth I: Tudor monarch (1558–1603); established Protestant settlement and resisted marriage. • Sir William Cecil: Principal Secretary & Lord Burghley; Elizabeth's most trusted Protestant statesman. • Matthew Parker: Archbishop of Canterbury (1559–75); drafted the 1566 Book of Advertisements. • Mary, Queen of Scots: Catholic cousin of Elizabeth; claimed English throne; fled Scotland in 1568. • Philip II of Spain: Catholic king of Spain and Netherlands; former husband of Mary I; rival to Elizabeth. • Robert Dudley: Earl of Leicester; Master of the Horse, royal favourite, and leading Puritan patron at court.

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 1.1 & 1.2

Classroom Protocol: Complete 5–10 questions as a Do Now bell-ringer at the start of each lesson, or quiz yourself across the term. Tick the review checkboxes (R1, R2, R3) after each spaced retrieval attempt.

ENQUIRY 1.1: THE SITUATION ON ELIZABETH'S ACCESSION, 1558

[/ 10]

1. Which Tudor monarch was Elizabeth I's father? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
2. Who was Elizabeth I's mother, executed in 1536? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
3. Which Catholic queen preceded Elizabeth on the throne (1553–58)? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
4. What religion was Queen Elizabeth I? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
5. What ancient English possession in France was lost in January 1558? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
6. Approximately how much Crown debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
7. Who did Elizabeth appoint as her trusted Principal Secretary in 1558? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
8. Which institution had the sole legal power to grant monarchical taxes? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
9. Which unpaid local officials maintained law and order in counties? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
10. Which northern kingdom was ruled by Mary of Guise in 1558? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3

ENQUIRY 1.2: THE 'SETTLEMENT' OF RELIGION, 1559

[/ 10]

11. What title did Henry VIII claim over the Church of England in 1534? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
12. What language was the Catholic Latin Mass spoken in? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
13. What term describes Protestants who wanted to purify the Church of all Catholic practices? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
14. What was the official fine for refusing to attend church under the 1559 Act of Uniformity? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
15. What title did Elizabeth I adopt under the 1559 Act of Supremacy? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
16. What English prayer book was made compulsory in all parish churches in 1559? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
17. What official set of 57 instructions enforced the 1559 Settlement? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
18. What was a Catholic called who refused to attend Anglican church services? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
19. How many Marian Catholic bishops refused the Oath of Supremacy in 1559? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3
20. Who was appointed Elizabeth's first Protestant Archbishop of Canterbury in 1559? ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ R3

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 1.3 & 1.4

Spaced Retention Target: Test yourself on previous weeks’ topics before starting a new enquiry. Frequent low-stakes retrieval prevents forgetting and secures Level 4 factual precision.

ENQUIRY 1.3: CHALLENGE TO THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT

[/ 10]

21. What Latin term means "the middle way", describing Elizabeth's settlement? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

22. Which white linen robe did Puritans refuse to wear during church services? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

23. Which Archbishop of Canterbury issued the 1566 Book of Advertisements? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

24. How many London priests were dismissed in 1566 for refusing to wear vestments? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

25. What object did Elizabeth place in the Royal Chapel that outraged Puritans? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

26. What Catholic movement aimed to stamp out Protestantism across Europe? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

27. Which Catholic king ruled Spain, the Netherlands, and the Spanish Empire? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

28. What region of England was most heavily Catholic in the 1560s? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

29. What council of Catholic clergy (1545–63) reaffirmed Catholic doctrines? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

30. Did King Philip II of Spain immediately attack Elizabeth in 1559? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

ENQUIRY 1.4: THE PROBLEM OF MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS

[/ 10]

31. Who was Mary, Queen of Scots' first husband, King of France? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

32. Which grandmother gave Mary Stuart a legitimate claim to the English throne? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

33. What religion was Mary, Queen of Scots? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

34. Who was Mary's second husband, found strangled after Kirk o'Field exploded in 1567? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

35. Whom did Mary marry shortly after Darnley's suspicious death? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

36. In what year did Mary Stuart flee across the border into England? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

37. In what northern castle was Mary first held under armed house arrest? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

38. What alleged love letters were presented to prove Mary murdered Darnley? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

39. Did Elizabeth formally find Mary guilty of murder at the York Inquiry in 1568–69? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

40. Which powerful Catholic noble family in France was Mary closely related to? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

ENQUIRY 1.1 (01–10): 1. King Henry VIII • 2. Anne Boleyn • 3. Mary I (Mary Tudor) • 4. Protestant • 5. Calais • 6. £300,000 • 7. Sir William Cecil (Lord Burghley) • 8. Parliament • 9. Justices of the Peace (JPs) • 10. Scotland
ENQUIRY 1.3 (021–30): 21. Via Media • 22. The Surplice • 23. Matthew Parker • 24. 37 priests • 25. A silver Crucifix • 26. The Counter-Reformation • 27. King Philip II of Spain • 28. The North of England (Lancashire, Yorkshire, Durham) • 29. The Council of Trent • 30. No (he hoped Elizabeth might marry him or ally with Spain against France)
ENQUIRY 1.4 (031–40): 31. King Francis II • 32. Margaret Tudor (sister of Henry VIII) • 33. Roman Catholic • 34. Lord Darnley • 35. The Earl of Bothwell • 36. 1568 • 37. Carlisle Castle (later Bolton Castle) • 38. The Casket Letters • 39. No (Elizabeth gave a "not proven" verdict to avoid executing a sovereign monarch) • 40. The Guise family (House of Guise)
ENQUIRY 1.2 (011–20): 11. Supreme Head of the Church of England • 12. Latin • 13. Puritans • 14. One shilling (12 pence) • 15. Supreme Governor of the Church of England • 16. The Book of Common Prayer • 17. The Royal Injunctions • 18. A Recusant • 19. All except one (27 out of 28 bishops) • 20. Matthew Parker

PUPIL: 	TARGET GRADE:	PREDICTED:	ATTITUDE: 12345
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MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 1					
#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
1.1	ENQUIRY 1.1: THE SITUATION ON ELIZABETH'S ACCESSION, 1558 Do Now Retrieval (p. 4): [/ 10]	p. 5	Q1(a) Feature: the role of the Privy Council in 1558 [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 5	Q1(b) Feature: the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	Q1(c) Feature: the challenges Elizabeth faced regarding marriage in 1558 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	Q2 Explain Why: Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became q... [12m]		[/ 12]
1.2	ENQUIRY 1.2: THE 'SETTLEMENT' OF RELIGION, 1559 Do Now Retrieval (p. 8): [/ 10]	p. 9	Q1(a) Feature: the Act of Supremacy (1559) [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 9	Q1(b) Feature: the Royal Injunctions of 1559 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	Q1(c) Feature: the Act of Uniformity (1559) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	Q3 Essay: 'Elizabeth's religious settlement of 1559 was completely successful... [16m]		[/ 16]
1.3	ENQUIRY 1.3: CHALLENGE TO THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT Do Now Retrieval (p. 12): [/ 10]	p. 13	Q1(a) Feature: the Vestments Controversy (1566) [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 13	Q1(b) Feature: recusancy in early Elizabethan England [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	Q1(c) Feature: the Puritan challenge over crucifixes [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	Q2 Explain Why: Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement... [12m]		[/ 12]
1.4	ENQUIRY 1.4: THE PROBLEM OF MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS Do Now Retrieval (p. 16): [/ 10]	p. 17	Q1(a) Feature: Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne [2m]	[/]	[/ 2]
		p. 17	Q1(b) Feature: the inquiry into the Casket Letters (1568–69) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	Q1(c) Feature: Mary, Queen of Scots' arrival in England in May 1568 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	Q3 Essay: 'The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the mai... [16m]		[/ 16]

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